



Wayward prices

iOS game 'Wayward Souls' seems to be getting even more expensive with the consecutive update. Read on to know more: <http://dgit.in/wywrprc>



Dark Souls 2: Launched!

After ages of waiting, Dark Souls 2 launched towards the end of last month – read the Rock, Paper, Shotgun first impressions <http://dgit.in/ds2rpsfi>

Workshop

Widget up your Last.fm

Making your Last.fm profile look more like your own personal space is always a fun and interesting thing to do. Here are a few widgets that will help you get started.

Level Up!

Here's a great widget that gives you your own Last.fm level, based on usage and veteranism: <http://dgit.in/lfmLuwid>

Artist Cloud

This widget created a world cloud of your highest played artists and puts it up on your profile: <http://dgit.in/artiscl>

Artist Logos

A nice long collage of logos that your favourite bands sport. It looks great on a profile: <http://dgit.in/lfmlogos>

Installing these widgets is quite easy – as you generate each widget, you are provided with a few lines of BBCode that can be embedded in your profile in the 'About Me' section. Simply copy-paste the code to add the widget to your profile.

An extensive list of widgets is available here: <http://dgit.in/ultlwmwid>

out-of-the-way media players, but for the popular and functional standard players, however, the scrobbler plugin works like a charm. So if you use Winamp, Media Monkey, Windows Media Player, iTunes, Songbird or VLC, the scrobbler will scrobble it all for you.

If you're using a media player not supported by the Last.fm plugin, well, as the Last.fm saying goes – If it doesn't scrobble, it doesn't count!

Scrobbling from your phone

The phone has become the next generation of MP3 player of sorts. Suffice to say, if you're an avid scrobber, scrobbling from your phone is a must. And Last.fm's tentacles reach deep into the world of smartphones. There is an official Last.fm app for every OS (except, maybe Windows Phones, but we'll get to that). The Android scrobber syncs with most

music players of today, if not there's always the ScrobbleDroid app. The iOS scrobber isn't as considerate. Due to reasons that probably have something to do with Apple's compatibility, the Last.fm app for iOS comes with its own music player. The player can detect music from your iTunes app, but scrobbling can only occur when the music is played off the Last.fm app. Playing music on the iTunes app does not scrobble for you automatically. At least, not yet. The Android app also has more personalization features. You can decide how long a song has to play to consider it scrobble-worthy and manually synchronize which players you want to scrobble from. At face value, the Android app is a lot more convenient and customizable. But at the end of the day, both apps scrobble well.

For Windows, the popular scrobber was created by a techie in the US called Arnold Vink. The App is called 'ScrobbleMe'. It's simplistic, like everything in a Windows phone and the scrobbles almost glitchless. The only downside one could see on using the app is the fact that it doesn't scrobble too well instantly. It saves your play logs, but takes some time to update them with Last.fm. It's a lot faster if you tap the 'Scrobble' button on the app and manually scrobble your plays. It is, however, at the end of the day, a scrobber, and is available on the Windows Phone Store at <http://dgit.in/scrme>.

Scrobbling from your MP3 player

This is a bit trickier than any of the previous options. Scrobbling from an MP3 player is not the easiest thing to do, but with some effort and a little patience, you can set up most MP3 players to scrobble. The easiest MP3 player to scrobble from at the moment is the iPod. iTunes updates your play count from both your iPod as well as the music you play on your PC itself. All you have to do is set up your Last.fm plugin on iTunes, and voila – instant scrobber for your iPod.

Few players (specifically Sony ones) other than the iPod are supported by a third party scrobber called Zenses. Zenses can be downloaded from <http://dgit.in/zensesscr>. Zenses links to your

Last.fm account, extracts metadata from your MP3 player and scrobles it for you. But for some reason that probably have to do with firmware, Zenses has trouble



with some brands. Some MP3 players do not create the .scrobble.log file which is used by scrobblers. One way to get around this limitation but which isn't entirely without risk, is by using a third party firmware that's been around for a while. This firmware is called Rockbox and is easily available online. It has its share of supporters and is quite straightforward to install. Installation instructions for Rockbox can be found at <http://dgit.in/rckbxinst>

Why scrobble at all?

Well, it's a personal choice. Music lovers may be loyal to their favourites, but they are almost constantly in search for more music to keep the fire burning. Scrobbling is a great way to get access to more music. Last.fm started scrobbling as a road to discovery. Your own personal music taste is analysed by code which at the same time cross-references it with the behaviour of other music lovers of similar taste, and suggests music based completely on your history of listening



to music. As new artists enter the music scene, scrobbling is a great way to pick and choose what suits your taste. And with the advent of the Cloud Age, new music is literally at everyone's fingertips. All you need is curiosity and the right code to nudge you in the direction you need to go. 